

DroidBall

The DroidBall is the physical identity of Overdex.

It is not merely a button.

It is the mechanical representation of the Battle Engine itself.

Its purpose is to communicate the engine's readiness through simple, tactile interaction.

Philosophy

The DroidBall should feel like a physical mechanism rather than a software widget.

Every interaction should suggest mass, momentum, and intention.

The DroidBall is not animated for entertainment.

It is animated to communicate state.

Design Principles

Mechanical Before Digital

The DroidBall should behave like a physical object.

Motion should imply weight.

Acceleration and deceleration should feel intentional.

Every movement should appear mechanically possible.

Quiet Confidence

The DroidBall never demands attention.

It acknowledges interaction.

It quietly communicates the state of the Battle Engine without interrupting the player.

Communication Without Words

The DroidBall never speaks.

It communicates through:

- Motion
- Light
- Timing
- Mechanical behavior

The player should understand its state without reading text.

Respect the Player

Repeated interaction should never become annoying.

The DroidBall may acknowledge repeated presses.

Each acknowledgement should become progressively smaller until no response is given.

The DroidBall supports the player.

It never competes for attention.

States

OFF

The engine is inactive.

No battle systems are running.

The DroidBall appears dormant.

DEPLOYING

The Battle Engine is starting.

Services initialize.

Observation systems prepare.

The DroidBall unfolds with deliberate mechanical motion.

CLOSED

The engine is active.

The overlay is hidden.

Battle systems continue operating.

The DroidBall remains available.

OPEN

The overlay is visible.

Battle information is being presented.

The DroidBall indicates an active tactical state.

COLLAPSING

The overlay is retracting.

Battle systems remain active.

Only presentation is changing.

SHUTTING DOWN

Observation systems terminate.

Resources are released.

The DroidBall returns to its resting state.

Responsibilities

The DroidBall:

- Starts the Battle Engine.
- Stops the Battle Engine.
- Opens the overlay.
- Closes the overlay.
- Communicates engine state.

The DroidBall does not:

- Display battle information.
 - Perform calculations.
 - Interpret observations.
 - Make recommendations.
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Relationship to the Battle Engine

The DroidBall is the player's mechanical interface to the Battle Engine.

It controls engine state.

It does not control battle logic.

The Battle Engine may continue observing while the DroidBall is closed.

Presentation and operation are intentionally independent.

Animation Principles

Animations should:

- Feel mechanical.
- Be brief.
- Reinforce state.
- Never loop continuously.
- Never flash.
- Never become decorative.

Motion exists only to communicate change.

When nothing changes, nothing moves.

Design Goal

The DroidBall should become familiar enough that players instinctively understand its state.

The best DroidBall animation is the one the player notices only once.

After that, it should simply feel like part of the hardware.